OFFICIAL NEWSLETTER
Arike Care

ISSUE
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COVER STORY · ERNAKULAM

Teach me, and go to the next home

A mason, a wound left too long, and the request that changed how his care worked.



Illustration: learning to dress the wound at home.

01 · COVER STORY

Empowered to heal

The best care is a partnership, not a service delivered.

The Arike team recently had the privilege of caring for a 60 year old gentleman who had spent his earlier years working in stone masonry. An accident at work involving a stray stone had left him with a severe leg wound. Through medical care and careful self-management, he kept the injury well under control for a long time.

Then his wife fell ill. He gave all his time and energy to looking after her, and amidst the demands of caring for his family his own wound went unattended and became severely infected. That is when they reached out to Arike.

Our team began visiting him regularly to clean and dress the wound. As the visits became routine, he made a deeply thoughtful suggestion. He had noticed the daily workload of our nurses and the number of home-bound patients waiting for them.

> **“I know you have so many people waiting for you, people who might need you more than I do. If you teach me how to do this, I can manage the dressing myself, and you can visit every other day instead of daily.”**
>
> Our patient, to the nursing team

Valuing his determination, the team guided him and his wife through proper wound care. Today an Arike nurse visits to do the dressing on alternate days, and he and his family confidently manage it themselves on the days in between. The shared responsibility changed the couple's outlook completely, replacing their early anxiety with a real sense of capability.

This story shows why patient and family empowerment matters so much at Arike. By taking an active part in his own healing alongside his family, he reclaimed his independence, and he made sure our nursing team could reach other patients who needed them more. It reminds us that the best healthcare is a true partnership, built on empathy, education and the shared strength of a family.

INTERN DIARIES

ഇന്റേൺമാരുടെ കുറിപ്പുകൾ

Sr. Nimmy · Rajagiri College

One of the most remarkable parts of Arike is the home-care service. I was deeply touched by the dedication of the nurses who visit patients at home and care for them in a familiar place. I saw nurses who went far beyond treating this as a job. They cared for each patient with the same affection they would show a member of their own family, taking the time to understand each person's circumstances, planning services around their needs, and working together to deliver them.

My fieldwork here became more than an academic requirement. It helped me understand compassion, teamwork, dignity, commitment and human-centred care, and it has left me with lessons I hope to carry into both my practice and my life.

Aneeta, Ananthu and Shamna · Don Bosco College, Mukkam



The one month internship was a valuable and meaningful learning experience. It gave us practical exposure to palliative care through home visits with the nurses and the wider team. We also ran a first-aid awareness class for NSS students at GVHSS North Edappally, and an awareness programme on basic health monitoring devices for members of a residents association.

Taking part in patient and caregiver interactions, day-care activities, documentation and telephone work strengthened our communication, observation, teamwork and empathy, and gave us a better understanding of the physical, emotional and social needs of patients and their families.

02 · ACTIVITIES · SEPTEMBER 2026

What we did this month

പ്രവർത്തനങ്ങൾ



6 September · Chottanikkara

KOODE comes to Chottanikkara

06
SEPT

The KOODE Chottanikkara Mekhala was inaugurated at Chottanikkara. Dr. George, Mr. Donal and Mr. Suhail took part, marking an important step towards stronger community-based palliative care networks and local support systems in the area.



6 September

KOODE at Thanal, Vaduthala

Dr. George, Mr. Donal, Mr. Praveen, Mr. Kareem and Mr. Suhail met the Thanal Residents Association to talk about community participation and stronger local support networks for palliative care.

Maamangalam

DIVISION 31

12 September

KOODE at the Elderly Club

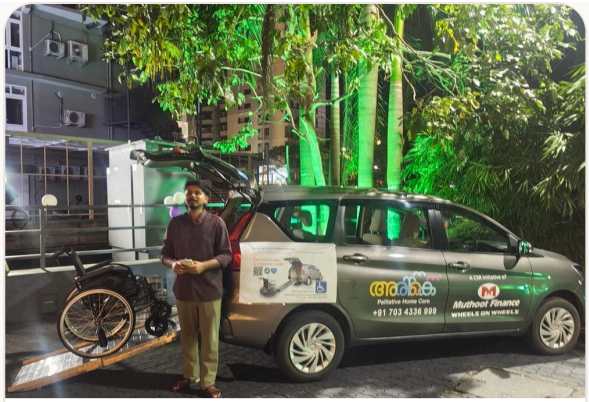
A sensitisation session introduced the KOODE initiative and the part neighbourhoods can play in supporting palliative care close to home.



17 September

First aid and home care

A training programme at Edapally Kunnumpuram covered the foundations of first aid, home care and palliative services for participants from the neighbourhood.



6 & 23 September

WOW campaign at the IMA

Team Arike joined the fundraising campaign at the IMA, and again at the general body meeting. Supported by the Muthoot Foundation, WOW lets wheelchair users travel without transferring.



23 September

UNARV at GVHSS Edapally

The UNARV programme ran at Government Vocational Higher Secondary School, Kunnumpuram, North Edapally, as part of our outreach and community engagement work.

Aluva

GRIEF AND SPIRITUAL CARE

16 September

Bereavement and spirituality

Mr. Donal and Mr. Suhail attended a training programme at Aluva on emotional, psychosocial and spiritual support in palliative care and bereavement.



24 September

KOODE meeting at SKFWRA

A KOODE meeting at SKFWRA, Kadavanthra focused on community engagement, strengthening local support networks and encouraging more residents to take part in the initiative.

STAFF CAPACITY BUILDING

Our team, still learning

ജീവനക്കാരുടെ പരിശീലനം



PACT

Mr. Vipin

Took part in the Palliative Care Accessibility Core Training, run by the Singapore India Foundation with Pallium India.



3 & 4 October · KILA, Thrissur

Ms. Saranya Sivan

Attended the state-level workshop on Palliative Care for Nurses, organised by APC Kerala.

03 · CARE INFO · FOR FAMILIES AT HOME

Sharing the caring within the family

പരിചരണ കുറിപ്പ്

Caring for a family member is demanding, and sharing the work makes it easier for everyone. When a family works together the patient gets steady support, and the load does not fall on one person alone.

01 Talk openly as a family about the patient's care and the support that is needed.

02 Share the daily jobs: going with the patient, preparing meals, helping with housework.

03 Divide the work by what each person can realistically give in time and ability.

04 Keep everyone informed when something changes in the patient's care or routine.

Small contributions count. Even a little help from each person lightens the load on the main caregiver and makes a real difference at home.

04 · SUPPORT OUR CAUSE

Free care at home, paid for together

ഞങ്ങളെ പിന്തുണയ്ക്കുക

With your support, Arike provides free home-based palliative care to patients within the Kochi Corporation limits. On average our team cares for 40 patients every day, ensuring compassionate support in the comfort of their homes. Nearly ₹10 lakh is required every month to sustain these services, and even this is not enough to meet the growing needs of patients and extend our services to more families.

Palliative care is not limited to managing physical symptoms alone. We also support patients and families through medicines, nutritional support, and assistance for the educational needs of children. We invite you to become a monthly supporter with a minimum contribution of **₹500 per month**.

Give online

arikecare.org/donate

SCAN TO GIVE

SCAN TO GIVE · UPI



OR BANK TRANSFER

A/C name	**Arike Day Care Nurses**
A/C no.	**13800100459765**
IFSC	**FDRL0001380**
Branch	**Palarivattom, Federal Bank**
UPI	**arike9765@fbl**



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Wheelchair users deserve barrier-free travel at zero cost. A vehicle with wheelchair access is available for travel at no cost to the family. Support our operational expenses and make every journey possible. Contribute now and empower a ride. For info, call **+91 7034 336999**.

A heartfelt thank you

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At Arike, every act of kindness becomes a source of strength for the patients and families we serve. We extend our deepest gratitude to all our supporters whose generosity, trust and encouragement continue to uplift our mission. Your contributions, big and small, help us deliver dignified, compassionate care to those facing serious health-related suffering.

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